

KITEWRIGHT LIFT · PRECIS

Kitewright Lift design precis

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.4	2026-10-04	Amish Chadha	Amish's round-3 decisions 8A, 9A and 10A (KWL-DDR-004); ColdCell's packs as drawn on a raised deck, the Core to the family envelope, payload shoes, rated payload 3.2 kg; numbers from KWL-CAL-001 v0.3
0.3	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Amish's decisions 34A and 35A (KWL-DDR-003); lighter fittings, lithium-ion ColdCell packs, frame-to-Core leads; numbers from KWL-CAL-001 v0.2
0.2	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	TRL 2 and 3; coaxial X8 with down-folding arms (KWL-DDR-001), constructable design (KWL-DDR-002), first-order numbers from KWL-CAL-001, safety section
0.1	2026-09-30	Amish Chadha	Initial scaffold

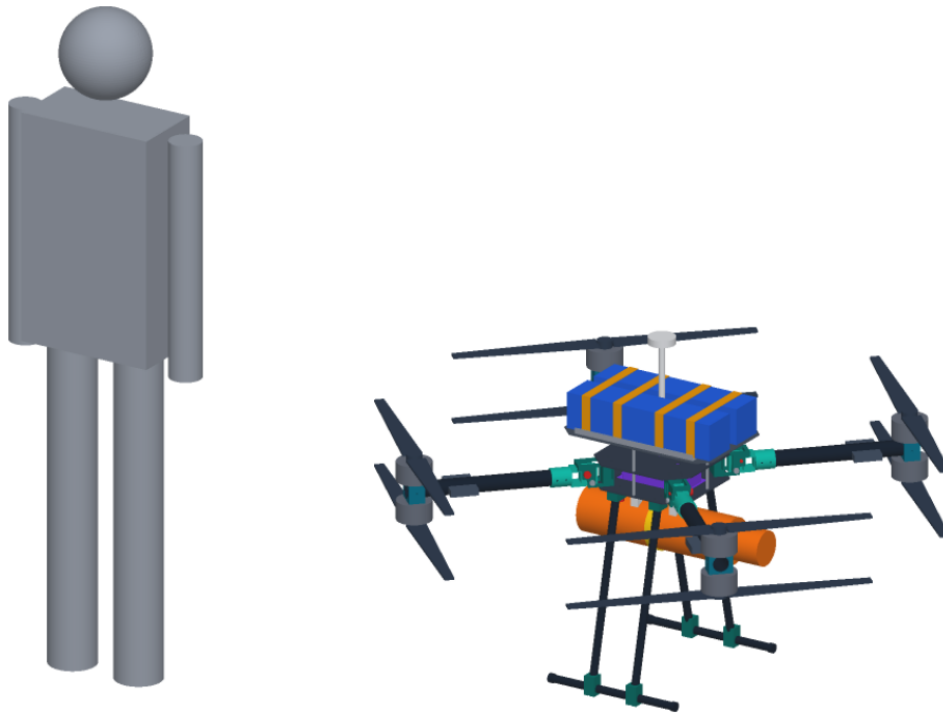
Kitewright Lift design precis

A multirotor frame for the Kitewright family that hovers, lifts, winches and flies on a tether in disasters and remote terrain.

Kitewright Lift

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/kitewright-lift

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION



Seen from the front right and above, 22 deg elevation. Grey figure: 1.75 m person for scale, standing beside the aircraft. Line-and-float release payload fitted under the hub

Figure 1. Kitewright Lift, flying-ready with the line-and-float release under the hub. CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION.

■ How it works

Kitewright Lift is a coaxial X8: four carbon arms on a two-plate carbon hub, each arm carrying one motor on top of its tip and one underneath, with 30 inch folding propellers turning opposite ways. If any one motor stops, its partner on the same arm keeps that corner flying, and the autopilot shares the load among the other arms, so the aircraft can still hover and land.

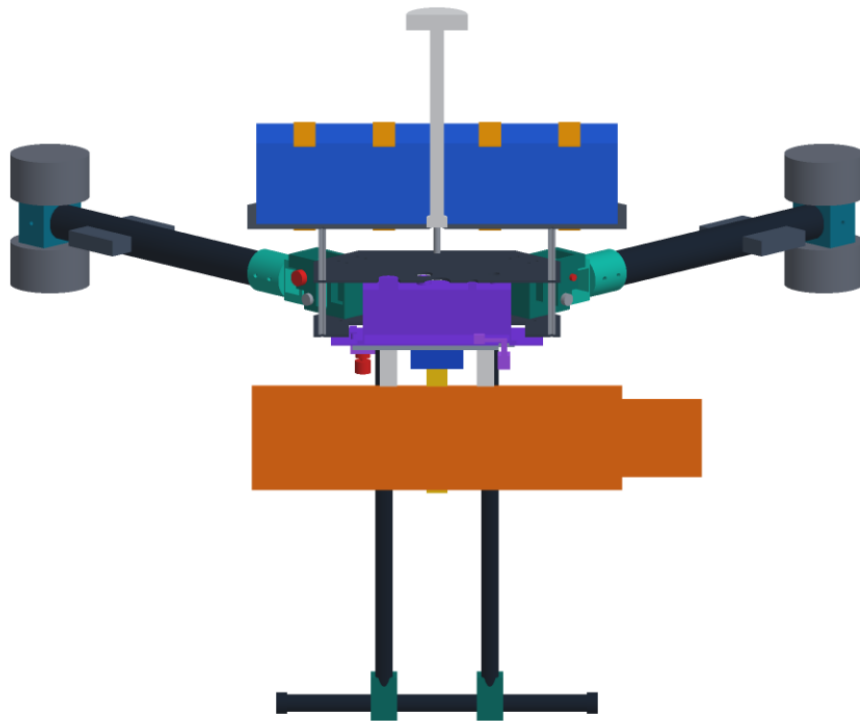
Each arm hinges on a machined aluminium block at a hub corner and folds down for transport. In flight the lift on the arm presses the arm's root fitting up against a stop bridge on the hinge block, so the arm cannot fold under power even if its lock pin were left out; the ball-lock pin only stops the arm drooping on the ground. Folded, with the propeller blades turned back along the arms, the aircraft measures about 0.88 x 0.48 x 0.45 m and fits the 1.2 x 0.6 x 0.5 m case of R9 with its landing gear on.

The Kitewright Core (autopilot, radios, power bus) hangs under the bottom hub plate to the family mounting envelope, its lid standing up through an opening into the hub. Two ColdCell packs, 410 x 94 x 94 mm and 4.46 kg each, sit side by side on a carbon deck raised above the upper rotors, held by guides and cam straps, with the GNSS mast between them. Under the Core, any Kitewright payload slides onto the Core's rail on its own payload shoe until it meets the front stops, two locking pins drop into the shoe, and the Core's DS-014 pigtail is plugged into the payload. Two payloads are designed here: the line-and-float release, which drops a foam float with 30 m of floating line to a person in water, and the tether module, which turns 400 V DC from a ground supply into the 51 V bus for hours of hover as a lookout or radio relay.

Kitewright Lift: cutaway

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/kitewright-lift

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION



Cut on the centre line, front half removed, propellers left out; seen from the front, 14 deg elevation. Core under the bottom plate with its lid up in the hub, packs on the raised deck, payload shoe on the Core rail

Figure 2. Cutaway on the centre line: the Core under the bottom plate with its lid up in the hub, the packs on the raised deck, the payload shoe on the Core's rail.

■ Components

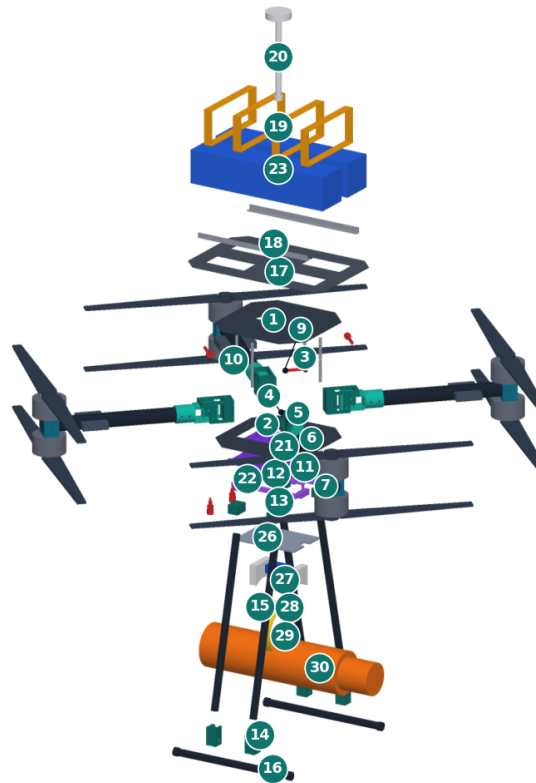
#	Component	Role
1	Hub plates and spacers	Two 3 mm carbon plates 280 mm square, 60 mm apart, on the four hinge blocks and four spacers
2	Arm hinges	Machined clevis blocks with stop bridge, 8 mm pivot bolt and ball-lock pin; arms fold down
3	Arms	40 mm carbon tubes bonded and bolted into aluminium root fittings and motor clamps
4	Motors, controllers and propellers	Eight motors of the 10 kg static thrust class, 80 A controllers on the arms, 30 x 10 folding propellers
5	Kitewright Core	Autopilot, GNSS, radios and the power bus with a tether input, unchanged from the Core design; hung under the hub to the family envelope
6	Battery deck and ColdCell packs	Two 14S3P lithium-ion heated packs (ColdCell variant for Lift) on a carbon deck above the hub, with Lift's own leads to the Core
7	Payload rail	The Core's rail, two locking pins and DS-014 pigtail under the Core plate
8	Line-and-float release	Fail-closed servo pin release, webbing sling, foam float with 30 m of line
9	Tether module and ground set	4 kW onboard converter and breakaway; 400 V ground supply, 60 m tether, reel, insulation monitor and emergency stop
10	Landing gear	Four carbon struts and two skids, 450 mm apart, in machined blocks
11	Winch module	Not designed until its patent screen is done; the payload bay leaves room for it

Kitewright Lift: exploded view

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/kitewright-lift

CONCEPT, NOT FOR FABRICATION

- 1 Top hub plate
- 2 Bottom hub plate
- 3 Hub spacers and deck standoffs
- 4 Arm hinge blocks (4)
- 5 Arm root fittings (4)
- 6 Arm tubes (4)
- 7 Motor mounts (4)
- 9 Arm lock pins (4)
- 10 Motors (8)
- 11 Motor controllers (8)
- 12 Folding propellers (8)
- 13 Gear top blocks (4)
- 14 Skid blocks (4)
- 15 Gear struts (4)
- 16 Skids (2) with end caps
- 17 Battery deck
- 18 Pack guides (2)
- 19 Pack straps (4)
- 20 GNSS mast
- 21 Kitewright Core (Core)
- 22 Core payload rail (Core) and Core DS-014 pigtail plug (Core) and Core locking pins (Core)
- 23 ColdCell packs (2)
- 26 Payload shoe, float release
- 27 Float saddles (2)
- 28 Release unit
- 29 Float sling
- 30 Rescue float and line bag



Seen from the front right and above, 20 deg elevation; numbers match bom/bom.csv. Arms, motors and propellers stay in place; hub stack pulled up, gear and payload pulled down

Figure 3. Exploded view; numbers match `bom/bom.csv`.

■ Key design choices

All decided on 2026-10-03 under Amish's pre-approvals (KWL-DDR-001 and KWL-DDR-002):

- **Coaxial X8** rather than a flat hexa- or octocopter, for motor-out tolerance and a compact fold.
- **Arms fold down against a stop.** Lift holds each arm against a fixed bridge; the lock pin never carries flight loads.
- **Controllers on the arms**, so only two power leads per arm cross the hinge.
- **Fixed skid gear** that stays on when folded; the folded motors clear the skids and the ground.
- **One payload shoe** for every payload, to the Core's drawing KWC-DWG-106, inside the Core's 88 mm payload neck.
- **Fixed-voltage tether** (400 V DC) with an isolated onboard converter and a breakaway, clear of adaptive-voltage tether patents.
- **No winch** until its patent screen is done.

■ First-order numbers

From KWL-CAL-001 (docs/04-calcs/sizing.py). All are estimates; nothing has been measured.

Table 1. First-order numbers.

Quantity	Value	Assumptions
Motor spacing; propellers	1,240 mm diagonal; 30 inch, 115 mm tip gap, 170 mm coaxial gap	cad/src/model.py
Empty mass (no packs, no payload)	12.9 kg	Made parts 5.08 kg from the model; motors 450 g, controllers 110 g, propellers 110 g, Core 0.99 kg, frame-to-Core leads 0.12 kg
Two ColdCell packs	8.92 kg, 1,361 Wh	ColdCell's 14S3P lithium-ion pack as drawn, 410 x 94 x 94 mm, 4.46 kg each
Take-off mass with the rated payload	24.98 kg with 3.2 kg (R1 limit 25 kg)	21.78 kg ready to fly; float release 1.46 kg, tether module 3.13 kg
Hover power, sea level, rated payload	3.2 kW	Coaxial factor 1.28, figure of merit 0.65, drive efficiency 0.80, 50 W avionics and payload
Hover time, sea level, rated payload	20.4 min	80 % of pack energy used
Hover time, 5,000 m and -20 C, 2 kg	14.5 min	Air density 0.743 kg/m ³ ; ColdCell delivers 85 % in the cold
Thrust to weight	2.88 at sea level; 1.84 at 5,000 m	10 kg per motor at full throttle, lower rotor 80 %
One motor out	2.24 at sea level; 1.43 at 5,000 m	Partner motor alone on the failed arm
Arm load at full thrust	177 N; 2.6 kN on the stop bridge	30 mm from pivot to bridge
Tethered hover	3.2 kW on the bus; 3.6 kW from the ground; 25 V drop and 225 W lost in the tether	400 V, 60 m, 2 x 0.75 mm ² , 95 % converter
Float drop	Expected miss 2.2 m from 10 m in 10 m/s wind	2 m position hold; drift aimed off to 30 %
Folded size	0.88 x 0.48 x 0.45 m	From the folded model
Warm-weather limit	Full hover flights to about 27 °C ambient	ColdCell's 50 °C warning, kept until measured (decision 9A)
Estimated cost	USD 6,627 for the aircraft; USD 3,976 for the payloads and ground equipment	bom/bom.csv , indicative prices

Value-engineering target: USD 5,000. Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 6,627 (USD 1,627 over the target).

Kitewright Lift: power flow in hover at sea level with the rated 3.2 kg payload (W, all values are estimates, KWL-CAL-001)

github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/kitewright-lift

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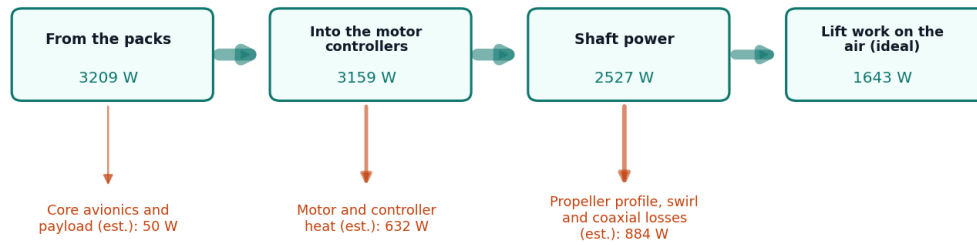


Figure 4. Where the power goes in hover at sea level with 5 kg (estimates).

■ Patent design-arounds

From the preliminary patent, trademark and prior-art screen (not legal advice):

- Generic multirotor frame; no specific frame patents identified in the preliminary screen. The coaxial X8 layout and a clevis fold hinge are long-established.
- Winch not yet screened: no winch design is published until a patent screen is done.
- Tether power is a fixed-voltage supply with onboard DC-DC, not adaptive tether voltage (Elistair US11059580B2, to 2037).
- Payload mount and power bus follow the Kitewright Core design-arounds (DS-014 connector with plain rail and locking pin; external-heater ColdCell packs).

■ Shared blocks

- Kitewright Core (autopilot, radios, payload mount, power bus with tether input)
- ColdCell (heated battery packs)
- AltiRig (propeller and motor data for thin air)
- AvalancheScout and LakeWatch (payloads)
- CalRig proof-load (arm hinges, tether breakaway)

■ Safety

Safety: Kitewright Lift is published as an open engineering reference, not certified aviation equipment, for civilian use only. No weapons, targeting or military payloads, and none will be accepted into the family.

Safety: Certification and operating approvals (FAA Part 107 in the United States, EASA rules in Europe, India's DGCA Drone Rules 2021, and the civil aviation authority wherever it flies) are out of scope at this TRL and will be addressed if prototypes progress. Builders must fly only where local rules allow.

Safety: Eight 30 inch propellers can cause fatal injury. Arm only with every arm lock pin in and flagged, every propeller checked, and nobody within 15 m. Write and follow pre-flight, arming and keep-out procedures before any powered test. The first power-up is done with the propellers off.

Safety: The arm hinges carry the whole lift. Each hinge is proof-loaded to 1.5 times its full-thrust moment before first flight, and inspected for cracks at the pivot and stop bridge after any hard landing.

Safety: Lithium-ion packs can burn fiercely after a crash, an over-charge or a cold charge. Follow ColdCell's rules for its lithium-ion variant: charging blocked below 5 °C, heater cut-outs, a fuse on every cell, charging only in the fire-resistant charging box on a non-flammable surface, and a crashed pack kept outside and watched for 24 h.

Safety: The tether carries 400 V DC, a dangerous voltage. The ground supply is isolated, with an insulation monitor, residual-current protection, an emergency stop and an earth spike; the tether never crosses roads, water currents or power lines, and nobody handles it while live. The breakaway at the aircraft parts it if it snags.

Safety: Never carry or lift a person. The float's line is tied to the float only, never to the aircraft. Nobody stands under a payload. Drops are made from 10 m or higher, because the downwash (about 7.4 m/s estimated at 10 m) can push a person in water under or knock someone off balance on snow or a roof.

Safety: Loss of link or thrust in thin air can mean a crash in remote terrain; failsafes are set and tested at each altitude band, and the first high flights are made over ground where a crash harms nobody.

■ Open questions

None for design. Amish decided the Kitewright family reconciliation on 2026-10-04 (KWL-DDR-004): ColdCell's packs as drawn, the 25 kg limit kept and the payload rated at what fits (3.2 kg). R4's sea-level case was restated the same day to "with the rated payload" as a consequence of 8A (KWL-DDR-005), so nothing is open.